

Mozambique

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** May 1, 1983 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red recalls the struggle for independence



Green symbolizes the riches of the land

Black recalls the African continent

Yellow symbolizes the country's minerals

The white fimbriations represent peace

Africa



Mozambique was a Portuguese colony before becoming independent under the single-party rule of FRELIMO in 1975.

The original flag of the *Frente da Libertação da Moçambique* (FRELIMO), the leading political party in Mozambique, also had green, black and yellow horizontal stripes separated by white fimbriations. In the hoist was a red triangle. The black, green, and yellow were derived from the flag of the African National Congress, used in South

Africa. On independence the colors were re-arranged to form the national flag, in rays emanating from the upper hoist. Over this was a white cog-wheel containing the hoe, rifle, book, and star which appear on the present flag. The flag was altered in 1983; the colors were arranged in horizontal stripes, and the star of Marxism was made larger.

EMBLEM OF MOZAMBIQUE

The hoe represents the country's agriculture

The star symbolizes Marxism and internationalism



The rifle stands for defense and vigilance

The open book symbolizes the importance of education